

Source Analysis Skills Book



Golden Gate Bridge, San Francisco, California, USA – Ros Keron Jan 2015

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Golden Rules of Modern History

Before focusing on source analysis skills, please be aware of the Three Golden Rules of Modern History:

GR#1: Answer the question being asked.

GR#2: Write in the third person at all times.

GR#3: Write in the past tense: *Was for Ros*

Interpreting Sources:

Historians interpret sources in order to gather an accurate and truthful representation of the past.

Therefore, the first questions an historian must ask are:

Is this an objective representation of the past?

Does this source have the ability to reflect the time period?

Does this source present a snap shot of the time period?

- Sources can be both reliable and unreliable as representations of the past. Are they authentic? Are they credible? Do you trust the source?
- There is often more to a representation or version of the past than what it actually says about an historical event or issue.
- For instance, anyone who attempts to represent the past is influenced by:
 1. Who they are
 2. How they view the world
 3. Their relationship to the time and events being represented
 4. Resources and information available to them
- History is not what happened in the past, it is ***what is said*** to have happened in the past.
- What one representation of the past says about an aspect can differ greatly from another representation.
- The task of the student of history is therefore, a challenging one: by carefully analysing many, and sometimes conflicting or **contestable**, representations, the historian has to make their own meaning of the past!
- Historians must therefore question every source. They must be critical of the sources.

- Historians must be critical readers. History students, therefore, are **critical readers**. This is a transferable skill which you can use in your other courses and in your day to day life.
- A source may be unreliable for many reasons BUT can be very useful.
- All sources can be **challenged**. That is, historians contest or debate the accuracy of all sources. This is called contestability.

Sources can be primary or secondary

Primary: Firsthand accounts or evidence from a particular time period created at the time of an event. They are often created to influence or persuade people.

Secondary: Produced or created after the particular time period and may contain evaluations of primary sources.

You should consider these terms when assessing the source but DO NOT include this in your response.

Why?

This is because students in primary school can identify the difference between a primary and a secondary source. You should, however, explain that it was a contemporary source produced at the time of the event OR a historian's report written with hindsight many years after the actual event.

Sources can be texts or graphics:

Photographs

Cartoons

Tables

Graphs

Newspaper Articles

Transcripts

Reports

Letters

Extracts from books

Historians' Evaluations

Diary Entries

Memoirs

Situation Reports

Posters

Others may include.....(Add to this list as you find different sources.)

For all senior school students, especially ATAR students, it is worth the time to prepare Source Folders. Collect sources along the way so you have a bank of sources to interrogate, dissect or unpack as part of your revision.

How to succeed in Source Analysis Tests

There are four simple steps to success in Source Analysis Tests:

1. Know your historical content knowledge
2. Understand the intent of each question – that is, what is being asked in each question; memorise the structure required for each response.
3. Practise analysing sources and acquire a sound general knowledge
4. Good time management

*Not all questions will be used by all students. Your teacher will tell you which questions you will cover in your tests. **Year 12 students cover ALL questions. ***

The questions you will be asked in Source Analysis may include:

1. The Historical Context
2. Compare and Contrast the Message
3. Usefulness
4. Perspective
5. Purpose
6. Tone
7. Contestability
8. To what extent do the sources.....
9. Evaluate the importance.....

Golden Rules to follow:

- Answer the question being asked. (GR#1) Focus on the marks allocation. The compare and contrast the message question is worth FOUR marks ONLY so it does not require an essay; you are not expected to include historical context.
- TPS: Think, Plan, Smash it out. Planning in Source Analysis responses is critical to addressing the question.
- Address the question using the key words from the question in the opening statement. This should be your mantra!!! For example: Explain the historical context of Source 3. Your opening statement should be: *The historical context of Source 3 was.....*
- Write in the Past Tense at all times. GR#3: *Was for Ros!!*
- Write well-structured TEXAY paragraphs. ONE per question ONLY. You must NOT leave a line between your statements, this weakens your responses.
- Include evidence from the source **when required**.

- Use your content knowledge to assist you in interpreting the sources. Show the marker you have studied Modern History. Draw on your historical knowledge.
- Write in the third person. GR#2
- *Never, ever, ever simply describe the source. See GR #1.*
- When selecting evidence, make sure you select the **best** and most relevant evidence to address the question being asked. *You will see in the examples presented, the evidence from the source varies. Avoid simply re-writing large sections of text.*
- You must apply your **historical knowledge** of the period of study to the sources. **General knowledge** is also extremely useful but without the historical content, you will not have a strong understanding.
- To improve your general knowledge, read the newspaper, watch the news, read articles outside of your interest and from a range of sources to broaden your depth of knowledge.

All responses must be written as TEXAY paragraphs.

TEXAY Paragraphs:

T: Topic Statement eg: The historical context of Source 3 was.....

E: Evidence: eg: as indicated by.....

X: Explanation, Examples, Expand

A: Analysis

Y: *YOU* Link to proposition OR *you* summarise the paragraph. Please Note: Not always required in the Source Analysis responses.

*You must **never use dot points** in your responses. They belong in note making and not in formal responses.*

Steps to successful source analysis**Brodie's Plan**

Follow the following steps for every source. *(Each step will be explained in detail in the following pages but it is critical you memorise the order listed below.)*

Step 1: Identify the elements of the source

Step 2: Historical Context

Step 3: Audience and Provenance

Step 4: Tone

Step 5: Motive

Step 6: Perspective

Step 7: Purpose

Step 8: Message

Step 9: Usefulness

Step 10: Contestability

Step 11: To what extent.....

Step 12: How important....

The first thing you should always do before analysing a source is to write beside the source the following letters only. This is called *Brodie's Plan*.

E: Elements
HC: Historical Context
A & P: Audience and Provenance
T: Tone
Mo: Motive
Ps: Perspective
Pp: Purpose
M: Message

U: Usefulness
C: Contestability

See the example on Page 8.

Please Note:

You should think about *each of the questions* before attempting to answer the question. You can not address the message of a source if you have not first thought about the historical context, audience, provenance, tone, motive, perspective, purpose and usefulness of the source. The message of the source, however, can assist you in understanding the usefulness or perspective.

You should never repeat any information in your responses and as these questions are used with three to four sources, this should not be the case.

Only one source has been used in this book for ease of introducing each concept. That is, there will be **three** or **four** sources to cover the questions in your tests and exams in senior school. (ATAR = 4; General = 3)

Step 1: Identify the elements of the source. (E)

Using a highlighting pen, highlight the key elements of the source.

This should always be completed as quickly as possible. You can not highlight in the ten minutes reading time but you should highlight the elements for each source as soon as you commence your working time on the source analysis section of the test/exam.

Look for:

When?

Where?

Who?

What?

Why?

Provenance – origin of source. When was it produced? Who produced it? Why was it produced? Motive? Purpose?

Reliability of the source?

Symbolism

Target audience

Tone

- You must note every element. That little item in the corner of the source may be critical to the message of the source.
- Select key words from texts.
- Note the captions in cartoons and photographs.

Identify the FOCUS of the source at this step.

Highlight the key words – elements – in the text below:

Source 1

Extracts from Mein Kampf 1924 by Adolf Hitler

E

HC

A & P

T

Mo

Ps

Pp

M

U

C

"Today I am guided only by the sober realisation that one does not re conquer lost territories through the eloquence of a polished tongue but rather through a polished sword, that it is through bloody struggle...If the German nation wants to end the condition of it's impending extermination in Europe then it must not fall into the error of the pre-war period and make an enemy of everybody; rather it must recognise its most dangerous enemy so that it can smash it with all its concentrated power.

The borders of the year 1914 mean nothing at all for the future of the German nation... On the other hand, we national Socialists must unshakeably hold on to our foreign policy goals, namely to secure for the German people the land on this earth that is their due.

Neither a Western nor an Eastern orientation should be the future goal of our foreign policy but rather an Eastern policy in the sense of the acquisition of the necessary clod of earth for our people."

You have now completed Step 1 so you can place a tick next to the E.

Step 2: Historical Context (HC)

This question asks you to **explain** or discuss in detail the historical context of the source, in other words, provide the background content knowledge to the **focus** of the source.

Include the relevant *events*, *people* and *ideas* depicted or represented in the source.

It also requires you to include:

- Causes of the event
- Details of the event but not consequences of the event depicted in the source.

*This is the one question you must **NOT** refer to the source. You are **NOT** to include any evidence from the source for the Historical Context question.*

For example: For this particular source it would be incorrect to include: "polished sword" as this is making reference to the source. You can, however, state that Hitler's ideology was clearly outlined in his book Mein Kampf.

Address the following:

- Identify the focus of the source. *The focus of the source becomes your opening statement.*
- Outline the causes and/or events which led to the focus of the source.
- Provide specific details for the focus of the source – ie. key dates, people, places, ideas.

Source 1:

Opening statement:

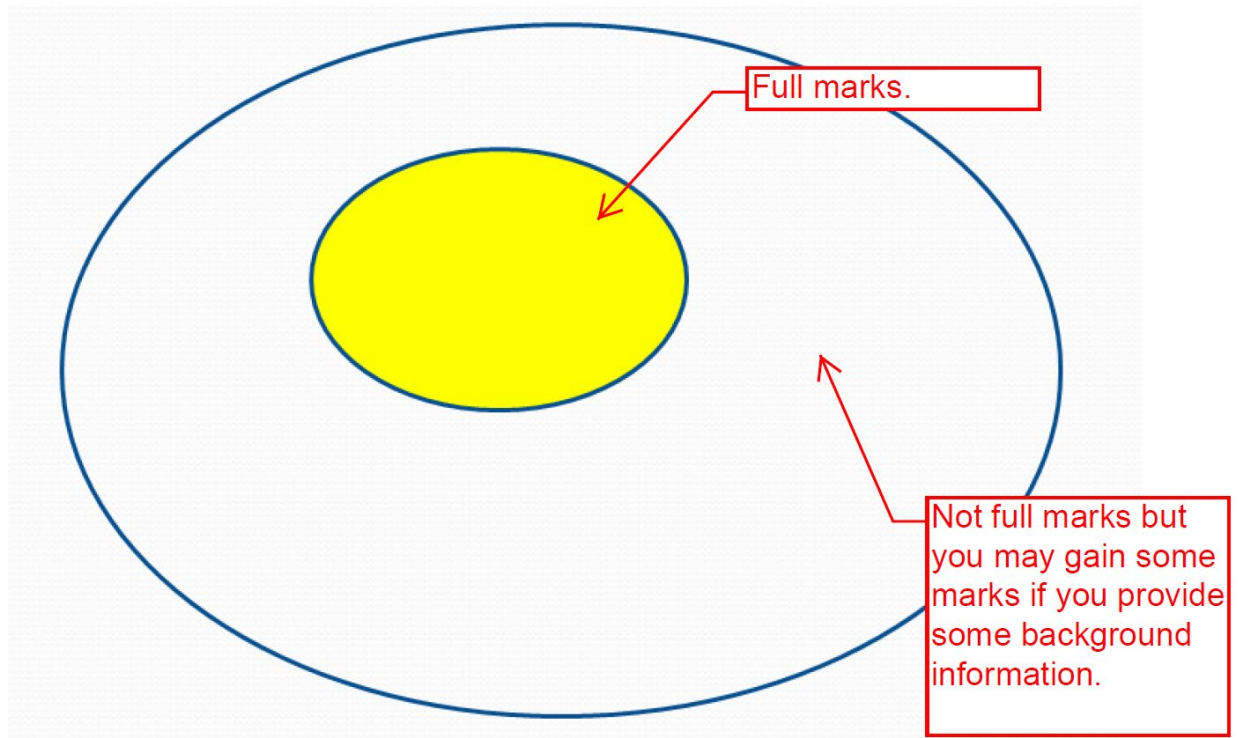
*The Historical Context and focus of Source 1 was Germany's **reaction** to the Treaty of Versailles.*

Content knowledge for this source *could* include:

- Germany's Defeat in World War 1 (1914-1918)
- The Armistice and abdication of the Kaiser
- November Criminals
- Treaty of Versailles – loss of territory, loss of military, war guilt clause. (These would be the most relevant terms of the treaty related to Source 1.)
- Origin of the Nazi Party (1919)
- Adolf Hitler
- 1923 Beer Hall Putsch
- Munich Trial
- Mein Kampf – ideology
- Features of Fascism – Strong Leadership, Extreme Nationalism, Supremacy of the Military.

Planning for this question:

All you need to do to plan for this question is to *crack an egg*. The yoke is the rich information which will give you top marks. You will only receive full marks IF you know the details and focus of the source. If you are not sure, you can simply provide the white of the egg or some relevant background information. This will not award you full marks but you may pick up some marks.



SCSA ATAR Marking Key

Question: Explain the historical context of **Source 3**.

Description	Marks
Identify the focus of the source	1
Outline the causes or events that led to the focus of the source	1
Provide specific details for the focus of the source, dates/events/people/place/ideas	1-2
Total:	/4
Note: This question is concerned with the historical context in which the source is located. The answer must concentrate on what is in the source and explain the relevance/significance.	

You have now completed Step 2 so you can place a tick next to the HC.

Step 3: Identify the intended audience (A) for the source AND the Provenance (P) of the source.

Audience (A)

This step is very important as this is where history responses and English responses differ. In History, you must never "set the reader" or "position the viewer" or "address the audience".

The audience must be specific to the source and will be used again in later questions.

For example, for Source 1, the intended audience would be the German people, specifically those who held similar views and were very angry with the Treaty of Versailles. This is because the extract was from Hitler's book *Mein Kampf*, a best seller in Germany in the 1920s. It would also have been intended for a wider audience in people from all countries who would be interested in reading about Hitler's views.

Provenance (P)

This is simply the origin of the source.

- Who wrote or drew or photographed it.
- When it was written, drawn or photographed.
- Where it was written, drawn or photographed.

For Source 1, the Provenance was that it was written by Adolf Hitler in his book, *Mein Kampf* after he was imprisoned for his unsuccessful Beer Hall Putsch* in 1923. It was first published in 1925 and the second edition was released in 1926.

This is very important as it is obviously a primary source which has been interpreted and evaluated by historians.

*Putsch – German for Coup D'état which is an illegal seizure of power.

You have now completed Step 3 so you can place a tick next to the A & P.

Step 4: Identify the tone of the source.

What is the tone in the historical sense?

IDENTIFYING THE TONE OF A SOURCE



Tone is a general attitude or emotion of a piece of writing or picture.

The tone of Source 1 would be a **determined** and **conciliatory** tone. Hitler has made it perfectly clear his intentions in regards to the acquisition of lost territory but is doing so in an appealing or conciliatory manner so as not to cause anguish or fear.

You have now completed Step 4 so you can place a tick next to the T.

Step 5: Motive (Mo)

This step is similar to Step 4: Tone. This is because although there is not a specific question on motive, it is critical in your understanding of the source to answer other questions.

Motive is asking you: WHY did the person create the source? What motivated this person. It is NOT the same as purpose – See Step 7 Purpose.

An example from outside this time period is needed here.

Imagine some Americans wanting to produce an anti-Donald Trump Poster for the 2020 Presidential Election.

What may have **motivated** this person to produce this poster?

Anger with President Trump's policies

The person may have been hurt by some of the policies.

Frustration

Envy – the person may have been jealous of the president's power

What would be the **purpose** of the poster?

To:

- warn others not to vote for Donald Trump
- promote another Presidential candidate
- alert others of the negatives of his policies

Therefore, the **MOTIVE** behind Hitler's extract was his anger at the harsh terms of the Treaty of Versailles and his perceived weaknesses of the Weimar Government who were not addressing the border issues.

Also, anger at the humiliation of the loss of World War 1.

Hitler was also **motivated** by his belief in German supremacy and his desire to regain the lost territory to make Germany great again.

Another **motive** would be that he was imprisoned and had time to reflect and collate his ideas for a better Germany.

Motive is very useful in addressing many questions.

You have now completed Step 5 so you can place a tick next to the Mo.

Step 6: Perspective (Ps)

You may address this question by using the following terms:

Positively biased towards or supportive of or sympathetic towards or supportive of.....

OR

Negatively biased against or critical of or opposed to.....

OR use the above to help you determine the perspective.

For example; the author was ~~negatively biased against~~ or critical of the terms of the Treaty of Versailles.

This is a stronger response.

There is a clear formula to use when addressing this question.

- Identify and state the perspective of the source
- Use evidence from the source to support your statement
- Explain *why* the author has this perspective. This is the account for. This is very important and requires you to draw on your content knowledge.

Repeat for the next source. You are **NOT** required to compare and contrast the perspectives. GR#1.

This question requires you to identify the perspective of the source and explain why the author had this perspective. Include evidence from the source to support your statement and include extra information from your content knowledge to further support your statement.

Motive – What motivated the source to be created?

Purpose – What was the intended outcome for the source when it was created?

Tone – A bright, happy, uplifting source will generally be *positively biased towards* whereas a dark, gloomy, sinister source will generally be *negatively biased against*. Be careful though as sometimes sarcasm can portray a different perspective.

Time – when was the source produced? 1924 when Hitler was in prison after his unsuccessful Beer Hall Putsch.

Please note: Time is important. Was it produced at the time of the focus of the source or years later? This will impact its perspective.

Place – where was the source produced? Munich, Germany.

Please note: Place is important. Was it produced in the country of the focus of the source or outside? This will impact its perspective.

You must **PEA** twice for this question as you will have two sources. Please note: **YOU MUST NOT** compare them:

- State the **Perspective**: The perspective of Source 1 was.....
- Include **Evidence** from the source:as indicated by.....
- **Account** for the perspective: This perspective can be accounted for by the fact that.....Discuss motive, purpose, time and place.
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- Include **Evidence** from the source:as indicated by.....
- **Account** for the perspective: This perspective can be accounted for by the fact that.....Discuss motive, purpose, time and place.

Step 6: Perspective

The perspective of Source 1 was negatively biased against or critical of the Treaty of Versailles' border changes. Hitler argued Germany was entitled to reclaim territory lost after the Treaty. Hitler outlined his ideology on the revenge against the Treaty of Versailles in his book Mein Kampf and promoted the conquering of lost territories "...through a polished sword and bloody struggle...." This perspective can be accounted for by the fact that Hitler argued that Germany should not accept the punitive treaty dictated to Germany by the allies and this drew widespread support from many Germans. The fascist belief in extreme nationalism and racial superiority also led to acceptance of Hitler's ideas. This extract from Mein Kampf, written in 1924, also identified the anger of many Germans to the crisis of 1923 which included the French invasion of the Ruhr.

P: Perspective

The perspective of Source 1 was negatively biased against or critical of the Treaty of Versailles' border changes. Hitler argued Germany was entitled to reclaim territory lost after the Treaty. Hitler outlined his ideology on the revenge against the Treaty of Versailles in his book Mein Kampf and promoted the conquering of lost territories "...through a polished sword and bloody struggle...." This perspective can be accounted for by the fact that Hitler argued that Germany should not accept the punitive treaty dictated to Germany by the allies and this drew widespread support from many Germans. The fascist belief in extreme nationalism and racial superiority also led to acceptance of Hitler's ideas. This extract from Mein Kampf, written in 1924, also identified the anger of many Germans to the crisis of 1923 which included the French invasion of the Ruhr.

Evidence from the source.

Account for

Use specific evidence from the source to support your statement.

Avoid including large *chunks* of the extract. Include dots to indicate there is more information either side of the words quoted as demonstrated in the above response. Remember, the marker has the source in front of them – as shown in the response.

In your response, explain why the author has developed that particular perspective.

You have now completed Step 6 so you can place a tick next to the Ps.

SCSA ATAR Marking Key

Question d: Identify and account for the authors' perspectives in **Sources 3 and 4** regarding|



Description	Marks
Articulation of the perspective of Source 3	1
Articulation of the perspective of Source 4	1
Analysis of the perspectives in relation to the question asked. This may include: • motives • bias • time • place • purpose	1-4
Total:	/6
Note: Students must consider the perspective of the sources in terms of the theme/force of the document study. To do this students need to: • Articulate the perspectives from which the sources were constructed or analyse reasons for the perspectives (Purpose/motive/place/time) • Use evidence of the perspectives from the source. • Identify how the author shows the perspective in the source.	



Step 7: Purpose

This question asks why the source was produced.

What was the intended outcome?

Please note: This is different to MOTIVE. Motive is what led to the source being created. For example: Anger at the harsh terms of the Treaty of Versailles and humiliation with the loss of World War 1 were the motives for the above article written by Hitler but this is NOT purpose.

SCSA ATAR Marking Key

Question b: Compare and contrast the purpose of Source 1 and Source 2.



Description	Marks
Articulation of the purpose of Source 1	1
Articulation of the purpose of Source 2	1
Identification of elements of comparison and contrast between the two sources.	1-4
Total:	/6
Note: This question focuses on the reasons for the construction of the sources, and what they aim to achieve. Candidates need to: • identify the issue/event/subject of each source • identify the message of the sources • identify the likely purpose for which the source was constructed (or in the case of the photograph, how the source might have been used, which might produce variations in student interpretation.) Explain how they compare (are similar) and contrast (are different) in terms of their purpose. A strong answer will integrate their comparisons and contrasts with the discussion of their purpose.	

Some words you can use for **PURPOSE** include:

TO:

- Inform
- Educate
- Instil confidence
- Provoke
- Reveal
- Create awareness
- Deflect
- Diffuse
- Reveal
- Consolidate
- Expose
- Legitimise
- Delegitimise
- Criticise
- Humiliate
- Alert
- Create propaganda
- Persuade
- Achieve power
- Eliminate opposition
- Challenge
- Strengthen opposition
- Gather support
- Highlight
- Cast doubt
- Warn
- Celebrate
- Justify
- Challenge
- Incite
- Exert control
- Support
- Ridicule
- Acknowledge
- Evoke sympathy
- Encourage
- Quantify
- Assess
- Influence
- Assert
- Mock
- Accuse
- coerce
- Influence and inform
- rally

The ONE word you should NEVER EVER use is ~~SHOW~~. With all these wonderful words above, show simply weakens your response.

The purpose of Source 1 was to **warn** the allies that Germany would take revenge for the harsh terms of the Treaty of Versailles and reclaim their lost territory. It was also to **criticise** the Treaty and **gather** or **garner** support for the National Socialist Party.

You have now completed Step 7 so you can place a tick next to the Pp.

Step 8: Message

Message is considered one of the most challenging questions on the paper although strong English students usually do well. It is asking you to identify the **essence** of the source which is more than just the focus of the source. *You are asked to identify what it is that the author of the source is trying to convey.*

By the time you have worked through each of the steps already outlined and completed Brodie's Plan, the message should be obvious to you. Try to identify the message without working through these steps in your head, you may find it challenging.

However, there are often many messages at various layers of the source so you must peel the layers of the source as you would peel the layers of an onion. To do this, you ask the "**So what?**" question.

You may use the following in your response:

The primary message of the source was that.....

The secondary message was that.....

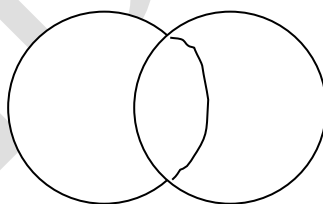
Please Note: You must use the word 'that' OR you will lapse into providing the purpose of the source.

This question requires you to provide evidence from the source to support your statements.

For the message question you will need to:

- Identify the message in each source
- Explain how the two sources are similar
- Explain how the two sources are different

Handy Hint: Use a Venn Diagram in your planning.



*The message of Source 1 **was that** Germany was to adopt an aggressive foreign policy to avenge the Treaty of Versailles. It was Hitler's "call to arms" to the German nation to not accept the harsh conditions outlined in the Treaty "...through a polished sword and bloody struggle." Hitler used his book Mein Kampf to outline his ideology which sought a stronger Germany, acquisition of lost territory and restoration to its former glory with a strong military. This message clearly supports the fascist features of extreme nationalism and supremacy of the military.*

SCSA ATAR Marking Key

There are two different questions for Message:

Question 1: Compare and contrast the messages of Source 1 and Source 2.

Description	Marks
Reference to the messages in Source 1 and Source 2	1-2
Points of comparison of the message(s) in Source 1 and Source 2	1
Points of contrast of the message in Source 1 and Source 2	1
Total:	/4
Note: Look for the message of each of the sources. Evidence should be sourced from the documents to support message.	

Question c: Describe the message of Source 3.

Description	Marks
Describes the message of the source	3
Outlines the message of the source	2
Identifies an aspect of the message of the source	1
Total:	/3
Note: Look for the message of the source. To do this: • read all the elements of the source (Title/author/date/location) • identify the issue/event/subject • identify the representation or opinion being expressed • provide evidence from the source to support the response	

You have now completed Step 8 so you can place a tick next to the M.

Step 9: Usefulness

PARRMT

This question asks you to *make an evaluation of the source for its usefulness*. That is, its **strengths** and **weaknesses** in relation to the *tag of the question*:

For example:

Evaluate the usefulness in terms of strengths and weaknesses, of Sources 1 and 2, as representations of *Hitler's ideology*.

Therefore, you must discuss how the sources/s addressed *Hitler's ideology*.

In other words, to what extent does this source have the ability to reflect the time period? To give an accurate snapshot of life at that time in one particular society? Was it an accurate representation?

As with the perspective question, there is a basic formula to be used to develop the response.

This useful/usefulness question is asking you to evaluate the sources.

This may include two parts:

Part 1:

Content covered – does this provide an accurate representation of the time period or does it provide additional content which would enhance an historians' understanding of the time period.

- Is it relevant to the period of study?
- Does it support the general narrative...for example, does the source support the general narrative of Hitler's ideology?
- Does it contain information already known about the time period?
- Does it provide new information?
- Is this information useful for studying the time period?
- Does it provide a different perspective?
- Does it reflect a common belief held by the vast majority at the time or a small minority only?
- Is the source reliable?
- Is the source biased?
- Are there major gaps or omissions in the source?

Part 2:

Provenance:

Primary/secondary nature of the sources Origin

Purpose

Limitations

Gaps/omissions reliability

Relevance

Context Bias

Look at the Provenance or origin of the source:

- When it was produced?
- Who produced it?
- Where was it produced?
- Why was it produced?
- What motivated it to be produced?
- What was the purpose for producing the source?
- Who was the intended audience?

You can remember the following:

PARRMT

P = Provenance

A = Accuracy

R = Reliability

R = Relevance

M = Motive

T = Time

Please note: Not all of the above may apply to each source but they are to be used as a guide only.

What historians say

Historians view the past through many different lenses. The view of a historian living very close to an event in **time** may be different from one who studied the event twenty years or one hundred years later. The influence of developments in the intervening years will affect the historical interpretation.

For example, German Nazi sympathisers in the 1930s would view this extract from Mein Kampf very differently to historians from the 21st Century.

The **motive** and purpose of the historian is also very important. Similarly, the writer's personal beliefs can distort their version of the past. If a writer sympathises with an historical figure, this will affect the historian's writing. Many other factors influence a historian's representation of the past, including their personal experiences and professional reputation.

For example, a Neo-Nazi who believes in the supremacy of the Aryan race and idolises Hitler would view this extract from Mein Kampf very differently to the historians who oppose white supremacy.

You must make your evaluation on the two sources collectively. To do this, create a simple framework as shown below.

Use the following in your opening statement or evaluation:

- Very useful
- Useful to a significant extent
- Useful to a certain extent only
- Not useful at all – *although it is recommended you don't use this one as all sources are of value and therefore useful*

When assessing the usefulness of the source, you must:

1. Look at the information conveyed in the source. Consider the following:

There are **six marks** for this question; simply three marks for each source.

Your opening statement should be an evaluation of the usefulness of **both** sources in how they address the question.

You should then evaluate each source. That is, in one TEXAY paragraph structured as:

Opening statement: Overall evaluation of both sources

- Evaluation of Source 1
- Strength of Source 1
- Weakness of Source 1
- Evaluation of Source 2
- Strength of Source 2
- Weakness of Source 2

This question is really asking you:

How useful is the source in giving an accurate reflection of the time period?

AND

Evaluate the sources for credibility, reliability, authenticity.

As you can see, there is a lot you can include so select your strongest points only.

The following might help!!

Think of yourself as an historian and the source is the **ONLY** information you have to provide information for the **tag*** of the question.

- Would it be enough?
- What information could you gather from that source?
- What are some issues or weaknesses with the source in providing an accurate representation?

Please Note: This question DOES NOT ask "What is missing?" so don't spend any of your time discussing what is missing.

Golden Rule #1: Answer the question being asked.

***Tag:** This is the final part of the question:

Evaluate the usefulness, in terms of strengths and weaknesses, of Sources 1 and 2 as representations of Hitler's ideology. Tag: Hitler's ideology

Source 1 was useful in representing Hitler's ideology to a certain extent only as it focused on only one aspect of his ideology. One major strength was that it clearly demonstrated the German and specifically Hitler's anger at the harsh and punitive Treaty of Versailles. This anger led to increased support for the Nazi Party. It made reference to the loss of territory and the reduction in Germany's military forces and Germany's intention to reclaim "...the acquisition of the necessary clod of earth...." through "...bloody struggle....," was stated. Supremacy of the military and extreme nationalism were also the features of fascism included and these demonstrated the popularity of fascism in Germany at this time. Written in 1924, the source was a clear representation of Hitler's ideology and reaction to the events of the previous year, the failed Beer Hall Putsch. The main weakness of the source was that it was the perspective of Adolf Hitler only and did not represent all Germans at this point in time. It was obviously negatively biased against and critical of the Treaty of Versailles.

You have now completed Step 9 so you can place a tick next to the U.

SCSA ATAR Marking Key

Question 2: Evaluate the usefulness, in terms of strengths and weaknesses, of Source 1 and 2 as a representation of |

Description	Marks
Provide example of a strength and weakness of Source 1 as a representation of America's political leadership.	1-2
Provide example of a strength and weakness of Source 2 as a representation of America's political leadership.	1-2
Evaluation of the usefulness of the sources in relation to America's political leadership.	1
Total:	/5
Note: Higher marks should be awarded to students who look at both the strengths and weaknesses of the sources provided in terms of <u>of</u> America's political leadership.	

Step 10: Contestability

Historians always **contest** or challenge interpretations of the past. They dispute interpretations of the past and thus view sources differently.

Historians **challenge** the sources and other historians' interpretations of the sources.

Generally accepted narratives can be challenged: *What is an **alternative** version of the event?*

One historian's interpretation of the past can be influenced by:

- Time of writing on the event and/or leader
- Place of writing on the event and/or leader
- Bias contained in the source
- Political ideas – for example one historian could be a left wing socialist and thus their interpretation will be very different to a right wing, conservative historian.
- Area of expertise – an Economic historian will have a different interpretation to a political historian.
- Orthodox Vs Revisionist: Orthodox historians tend to support the generally accepted narrative and Revisionist historians tend to challenge these accepted narratives.
- Position in society.

Therefore, all sources can be contested and you cover this question every time you study a source.

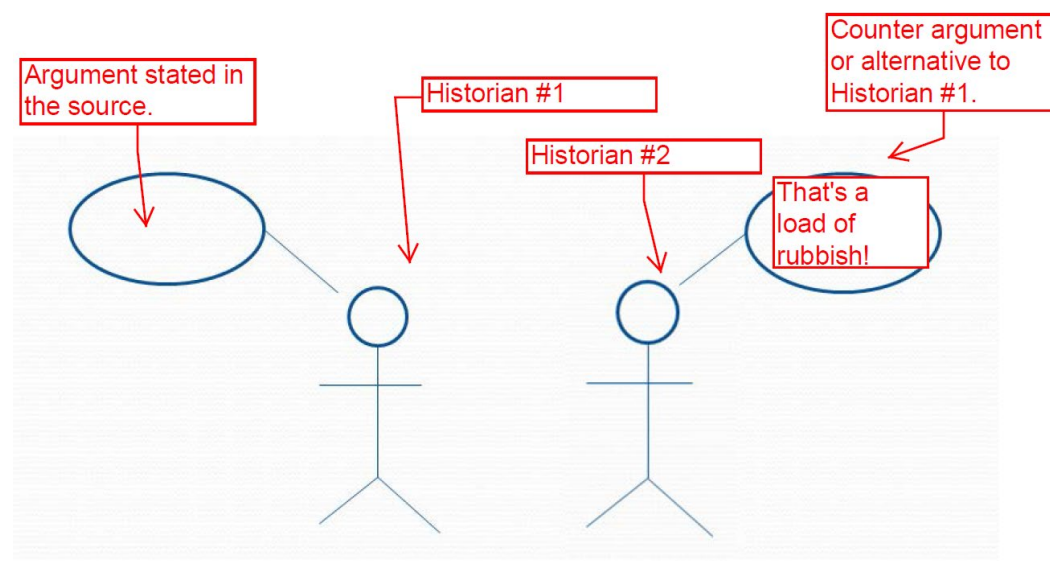
You will be given two sources for contestability.

You are to discuss each source **separately** although they may be related with a theme.

You must identify the argument presented in the source and then explain what counter arguments could be presented.

For your planning, simply draw the two stick figures next to your sources.

They represent two historians.



For this source on Mein Kampf:

The argument is Hitler's from his book, Mein Kampf written in 1924:

Argument 1:

The argument presented in Source 2 was that Hitler believed Germany needed to use force to conquer land owed to them as a result of the humiliating Treaty of Versailles, that they were only claiming what was rightfully theirs. This source was contestable due to the bias presented in that it was written by Hitler. This argument could be supported and the blame for future annexations on the Western Democracies which created the Treaty based on the Western Allies who created this punitive treaty. This argument could be contested, however, as it could be argued that Hitler laid out his aims for military expansionism and the conquest of new lands or living space, Lebensraum, and that the warning signs were there for the entire world to see. Some might argue that Hitler had thrown down the gauntlet to the western allies and that his desire for world domination was evident at this very early stage and was not only related to the Treaty of Versailles as Hitler always wanted world domination.

SCSA ATAR Marking Key

Question d: Identify how and discuss why Sources 3 and 4 are contestable.



Description	Marks
Identifies the element/s of contestability for Sources 3 and 4	1-2
Discussed the reasons for the contestability of Source 3	1-2
Discusses the reasons for the contestability of Source 4	1-2
Total:	/6
Note: The concept of contestability requires a discussion of conflicting historical interpretations represented in source material, specifically why they are different and open to debate. Answers should: Demonstrate an understanding of what can make a source contestable, whether it provides a certain interpretation of events for which other interpretations exist; or whether the source/s can be disputed as historical evidence Identify in each source the argument/s, biases, motives or perspective that can be disputed. Stronger candidates may discuss the nature of the contestability, perhaps by referring to alternative arguments or viewpoints on the interpretations presented by the sources, or by making comparisons between the two sources.	

You have now completed Step 10 so you can place a tick next to the C.

Step 11: To what extent.....?

This is the final and most challenging question on the paper.

It requires you to make an evaluation or judgement on the six or seven sources collectively. You should group the sources into a common theme or idea and evaluate the importance of each group. You must also discuss what is omitted or missing from the sources and evaluate the importance of this.

You must always address the tag of the question.

For example:

To what extent do the six sources represent features of fascism?

You must answer the question by making an evaluative statement as your opening statement:

The six sources represented features of fascism to:

- a significant extent
- a considerable extent
- a great extent
- some extent only...
- a certain extent only
- a limited extent
- a minimal extent

All sources must be acknowledged.

You should NEVER simply go through each Source. Eg Source 1 demonstrated.....Source 2 demonstrated this.....Source 3 demonstrated this.....Source 4 demonstrated this.....

This is what markers call a Shopping List and you will be penalised for simply doing this.

You must always plan this response.

An example can not be given for only one source but.....

Source One represented the features of fascism to a limited extent as not all factors were included.

SCSA ATAR Marking Key

Question e: Evaluate the extent to which the four sources give an accurate insight into American political leadership between 1907 and 1941.



Description	Marks
Articulation of the different aspects of the American economy between 1907 and 1941.	2
Identification of aspects of the American economy between 1907 and 1941. that have been omitted.	1
Evaluation of the extent to which the sources reflect the significance of the American economy between 1907 and 1941.	1-3
Total:	/6
Note: The intent is to not have a list of what has been omitted, rather students need to focus on what the sources do tell them about the context studied and why it may have been significant to highlight that, plus the impact of this on American society. Students should include	

Step 12: How important.....

This question will be covered in Webex lessons as it is very challenging.

Year 12 Students ONLY:

Please take the time to read the following from a 2019 student who shared how she tackled this question.

Courtesy of Abigail Caneda from Northam

Using your knowledge of the period of study, evaluate the importance of changing economic circumstances represented in the four sources.

The four sources represented the importance of changing economic circumstances to reunify Europe to a certain extent. The Marshall Plan of 1948 was an aid operation formulated by America to industrialise and help reinvigorate the European economy. This was because the Americans saw an economically stable, peaceful and secure Europe as crucial to the containment of the spread of communism. The changing in Europe's economic circumstances led to a peaceful Europe and better integration with the Western Bloc, as shown in Sources 2 and 4. Germany was divided into four zones after agreements were made at the Yalta and Potsdam Conferences in 1945, as shown in Source 1. The establishment of the European Common Market and the European Economic Community helped reunify and divide Europe. These communities both facilitated better trading relations and integration in Europe. However, these also saw the Soviet Union increasingly drifting away from integration due to concern and unease of being overpowered by a united Europe, as shown in Source 3. Although changes in the economic circumstances did contribute to the reuniting of Europe, other non-economic factors such as NATO, arms limitation talks (SALT 1 and SALT 2) and other significant events should also be considered.

How did I achieve this answer?

BEFORE EXAM – REVISION TECHNIQUES

- After making sure that content knowledge is sufficient, READ THROUGH THE SYLLABUS
 - Knowing the syllabus dot points helps because they can joggle your memory and help with evaluating the extent to which the four sources were able to accurately represent the tag of the question
 - Knowing the syllabus dot points will also help with determining omissions

DURING THE EXAM – ANSWERING THE QUESTION

1. Read the question carefully and check that you have the right set in front of you.
2. Answer the question in the first sentence – incorporating the keywords into this sentence will help make sure that you are answering what the question is looking for.
 - Don't just simply state how important it was. Also say what they led to.
 - They were important, so what? Why were they so important?

3. Identify the main events/ideas/people/etc. represented in the source, and how they led to change – this will be what the answer would mostly consist of
4. Ask yourself these questions, referring back to the syllabus dot points because the sources won't have anything that the syllabus didn't cover.
 - What did the sources include?
 - What did they omit?
 - If you're a visual type of person, I find that making a mental mind map works but otherwise, just keep the answers in mind
5. Evaluate the importance of changing economic circumstances and relate these circumstances to how they were represented in the sources
 - The main subject of this section would be the answers from the "included" section from number 4.
6. Towards the end, briefly mention what the sources omitted – in this instance, I said that the importance of changing economic circumstances to reunify Europe *to a certain extent*. This is where I like to put my counterargument by saying what the sources omitted and what other forces were critical to reaching what you said in your opening statement, in this case, the reunification of Europe.
 - Main subject would be from the "omitted" section from number 4.

Appendix:

Framework OR Skeleton

Courtesy: Caitlin Stone 2017

- 1) Compare and Contrast the message of S1 and S2 (4 marks)

The message of source 1 was that... as indicated by..... +evidence from source.

The message of source 2 was that... as indicated by..... +evidence from source.

The messages were comparable or similar because.....

However, they contrasted or were different because.....

- 2) Evaluate the usefulness, in terms of strengths and weaknesses of S1 and S2 as representations of... (6 marks)

S1 and S2 were useful to a ... extent.

Evaluation of S1.....

One strength of S1 was...

A weakness of S1 was...

Evaluation of S2 was.....

One strength of S2 was...

A weakness of S2 was...

- 3) Explain the historical context of S3 (3 marks)

The historical context and focus of S3 was...

The cause/events leading to this focus was...

Provide events/details/people/ideas

- 4) Identify and account for the authors perspective in S3 and S4. (6 marks)

The perspective of S3 was... (critical/opposing or praising/supportive)

As indicated by..... + evidence from source

This perspective could be accounted for because.....

The perspective of S4 was...

As indicated by..... + evidence from source

This perspective could be accounted for because.....

...

Analysis of perspectives in relation to:

- Motive
- Time
- Bias
- Purpose

- 5) Evaluate the extent to which the four sources give and accurate insight into...(6 marks)

*The four sources give and accurate insight into ... to a ... extent
Different aspects of the focus that are shown...and their importance to the tag of the question.
Different aspects that are omitted... and their importance to the tag of the question.*

Set 2

- 1) Explain the historical context of S1. Include the relevant events, people and ideas depicted or represented in the source. (3 marks)

The historical context and focus of S1 was...

Causes or events that led to this were...

Details/events/people/ideas/places...

- 2) Compare and contrast the purpose of S1 and S2 (6 marks)

The purpose of S1 was to... As indicated by..... + evidence from source

The purpose of S2 was to... As indicated by..... + evidence from source

Both sources compare or were similar because...

However, they contrast or were different because.....

- 3) Identify and explain the message of S3 (3 marks)

The message of S3 was... As indicated by..... + evidence from source

Identify the impact on the bigger picture...

Why is the source saying this?...

- 4) Identify and discuss why S3 and S4 are contestable... (6 marks)

The argument presented in S3 was...

This argument could be contested because...

The argument in S4 was...

This argument could be contested because...

Question e: Using your knowledge of the whole period of study, evaluate the importance of the themes, ideas and/or events represented in the **four** sources. (7 marks)

*The idea of.....or theme ofor event NAME
EVENT was very important to the European Region as or
because.....*

*Explain why this idea or theme or event was important. If the idea was
containment, you must explain why it was important to the region of Europe.
Give examples of containment beyond those shown in the sources.*

*Of greater importance, however, was European Reintegration. Nothing could
be more important to the peace and stability of the European Region than
Reintegration. To unite a region which had been divided due to conflicting
ideologies and affecting the lives of millions who were separated and
dislocated was critical. Also, a peaceful, stable and prosperous Europe meant
a peaceful, stable and prosperous world.*

Created by Ros Keron
Edited: 7th November 2019

Please refer to the next page for a graphic organiser.

Copy and paste the following graphic organiser to deconstruct sources OR complete the following:

Source	Eg Extract from Mein Kamp						
Elements							
Historical Context							
Audience							
Provenance							
Tone							
Motive							
Perspective							
Purpose							
Message							
Usefulness							
Contestability							

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